

Chartered Accountant (CA) Roadmap Pakistan

Regulated by the Institute of Chartered Accountants of Pakistan (ICAP) • Education and Training Scheme 2025

18 STREAMLINED PAPERS

• AI & DATA ANALYTICS INTEGRATED

The Institute of Chartered Accountants of Pakistan (ICAP) implements the **Education and Training Scheme 2025**, streamlining the qualification structure from 21 to 18 papers. This modern curriculum embeds crucial contemporary focus areas such as technology, artificial intelligence, data analytics, governance, and sustainability.

Level 1: PRC (Pre-Requisite Competencies)

Foundational stage compressed from 5 papers down to 3 essential quantitative, communication, and economic skill sets.

- **PRC-1:** Fundamentals of Accounting (Merged and renamed from Introduction to Accounting)
- **PRC-2:** Quantitative Analysis for Business
- **PRC-3:** Business and Economic Insights (Includes English Communication Skills)

Level 2: CAF (Certificate in Accounting and Finance)

The intermediate professional stage building technical core competencies, updated with dedicated digital systems and legal integration.

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| • CAF-1: Financial Accounting and Reporting | • CAF-5: Management Accounting |
| • CAF-2: Taxation Principles and Compliance | • CAF-6: Corporate Reporting |
| • CAF-3: Data, Systems and Risks (New technology & risk module) | • CAF-7: Business Insights and Analysis |
| • CAF-4: Business Law Dynamics (Merged Business & Company Law) | • CAF-8: Audit and Assurance Essentials |

Level 3: CFAP (Certified Finance and Accounting Professional)

Advanced professional stage focusing on complex corporate reporting, sustainability standards, and sophisticated financial strategies.

- **CFAP-1:** Advanced Corporate Reporting
- **CFAP-2:** Corporate Laws and Governance
- **CFAP-3:** Sustainability Reporting and Assurance (Newly introduced ESG focus)
- **CFAP-4:** Strategic Business Finance
- **CFAP-5:** Tax Practices and Planning
- **CFAP-6:** Audit, Assurance and Data (Integrated with AI and Data Analytics prerequisites)

Level 4: Strategic Case Study (SCS)

Replaced the former multi-subject assessment (MSA-1 and MSA-2) tier with a single, highly integrated evaluation.

- **Strategic Case Study (SCS):** Evaluates the candidate's holistic capacity to synthesize workplace experience, high-level ethics, data analytics, and advanced multidisciplinary scenarios into sound executive judgements.

Practical Training & Timelines

- **Mandatory Practical Training (Articleship):** Standard duration of **3.5 years** under an ICAP-approved training organization, featuring flexible entry pathways (e.g., option to commence training after clearing CAF thresholds).
- **Fastest Possible Timeline:** Absolute best-case fast-track qualification timeline spans **3.5 to 4 years** to earn the Associate Chartered Accountant (ACA) designation, assuming continuous progression without exam retakes.